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一、文章中英文主旨

中文主旨

本文围绕“人类进化已经停止”这一核心论点展开，先后从男性死亡率差异消失、人类生育率普遍趋同两个维度，论证了自然选择的效力已大幅减弱；最终指出，机器与社会的发展替代了生物层面的进化，人类的生物进化已然终结，未来人类的身体特征不会发生显著改变。

英文主旨

This article centers on the core argument that "human evolution has come to an end". It demonstrates that the effectiveness of natural selection has been greatly weakened from two dimensions: the disappearance of male mortality difference and the general convergence of human fertility rates. Finally, it points out that the development of machines and society has replaced biological evolution, human biological evolution has ended, and the physical characteristics of human beings will not change significantly in the future.

二、逐句解析（分段落）

第一段

1. **原文**: Being a man has always been dangerous.

译文: 身为男性，从来都伴随着风险。

常考词汇/短语:

- being a man 身为男性
- dangerous adj. 危险的，有风险的

2. **原文**: There are about 105 males born for every 100 females, but this ratio drops to near balance at the age of maturity, and among 70-year-olds there are twice as many women as men.

译文: 男女出生比例约为105:100，但到了成年期，这一比例便下降至近乎持平，而在70岁的老人中，女性的数量是男性的两倍。

常考词汇/短语:

- ratio n. 比率，比例
- drop to 下降至
- balance n. 平衡
- maturity n. 成年，成熟
- twice as many as 是...的两倍

长难句结构分析:

本句为 but 和 and 连接的并列复合句:

- 分句1: there be句型，核心结构 **There are about 105 males born for every 100 females**，说明男女出生比例；
- 分句2: but 引导转折，主干 **this ratio drops to near balance**，**at the age of maturity** 为时间状语；
- 分句3: and 引导并列，there be句型，**among 70-year-olds** 为地点状语，主干 **there are twice as many women as men**，说明老年群体的性别数量差异。

3. **原文**: But the great universal of male mortality is being changed.

译文: 但男性死亡率高这一普遍现象正在发生改变。

常考词汇/短语:

- universal n. 普遍现象，普遍原则
- mortality n. 死亡率

- is being changed 正在被改变（现在进行时的被动语态）

4. **原文**: Now, boy babies survive almost as well as girls do.

译文: 如今，男婴的存活率几乎和女婴持平。

常考词汇/短语:

- survive v. 存活，幸存
- as well as 和...一样好

5. **原文**: This means that, for the first time, there will be an excess of boys in those crucial years when they are searching for a mate.

译文: 这意味着，在男性寻找伴侣的关键年龄段，将首次出现男孩数量过剩的情况。

常考词汇/短语:

- for the first time 首次
- excess n. 过剩，过量
- crucial adj. 关键的，至关重要的
- search for a mate 寻找伴侣

长难句结构分析:

主句主干 This means that..., that 引导宾语从句:

- 宾语从句主干 there will be an excess of boys, in those crucial years 为时间状语;
- when 引导定语从句，修饰先行词 those crucial years, 从句主干 they are searching for a mate。

6. **原文**: More important, another chance for natural selection has been removed.

译文: 更重要的是，自然选择发挥作用的又一个机会消失了。

常考词汇/短语:

- more important 更重要的是
- natural selection 自然选择
- remove v. 移除，消除

7. **原文**: Fifty years ago, the chance of a baby (particularly a boy baby) surviving depended on its weight.

译文: 50年前，婴儿（尤其是男婴）的存活概率取决于其体重。

常考词汇/短语:

- depend on 取决于，依赖
- particularly adv. 尤其，特别

8. **原文**: A kilogram too light or too heavy meant almost certain death.

译文: 体重过轻或过重一公斤，几乎就意味着必死无疑。

常考词汇/短语:

- certain adj. 必然的，确定的
- death n. 死亡

9. **原文**: Today it makes almost no difference.

译文: 如今，体重几乎不会产生任何影响。

常考词汇/短语:

- make no difference 没有影响，不起作用

10. **原文**: Since much of the variation is due to genes, one more agent of evolution has gone.

译文: 由于这种差异很大程度上是由基因决定的，进化的又一个驱动因素也消失了。

常考词汇/短语:

- variation n. 差异，变化
- due to 由于，因为
- gene n. 基因
- agent n. 动因，驱动因素
- evolution n. 进化

长难句结构分析:

主从复合句，Since 引导原因状语从句:

- 从句主干 much of the variation is due to genes ;
- 主句主干 one more agent of evolution has gone 。

第一段段落概括

本段以男性死亡率的变化为切入点，指出过去男性存活风险远高于女性的状况已发生改变，男婴存活率与女婴近乎持平；同时，体重对婴儿存活的影响也近乎消失，而这种体重差异多由基因决定，因此自然选择的作用被大幅削弱，人类进化的又一个核心动因不复存在。

第二段

1. **原文**: There is another way to commit evolutionary suicide: stay alive, but have fewer children.

译文: 还有另一种方式会导致进化停滞: 人能活得更久, 但生育的子女更少了。

常考词汇/短语:

- commit suicide 自杀
- evolutionary adj. 进化的
- stay alive 存活, 活着

2. **原文**: Few people are as fertile as in the past.

译文: 很少有人像过去那样拥有旺盛的生育能力。

常考词汇/短语:

- fertile adj. 能生育的, 繁殖力强的

3. **原文**: Except in some religious communities, very few women have 15 children.

译文: 除了在部分宗教社群中, 极少有女性会生育15个孩子。

常考词汇/短语:

- except prep. 除了
- religious communities 宗教社群

4. **原文**: Nowadays the number of births, like the age of death, has become average.

译文: 如今, 生育数量和寿命一样, 都趋于平均化。

常考词汇/短语:

- nowadays adv. 如今, 现今
- average adj. 平均的, 普通的

5. **原文**: Most of us have roughly the same number of offspring.

译文: 我们大多数人的子女数量都大致相同。

常考词汇/短语:

- roughly adv. 大致, 大约
- offspring n. 子女, 后代

6. **原文**: Again, differences between people and the opportunity for natural selection to take advantage of it have diminished.

译文: 再一次, 人与人之间的差异, 以及自然选择利用这种差异发挥作用的机会, 都已经减少了。

常考词汇/短语:

- take advantage of 利用
- diminish v. 减少, 降低, 削弱

长难句结构分析:

本句为主谓结构, 主干为 differences... and the opportunity... have diminished:

- between people 作后置定语, 修饰 differences;
- for natural selection to take advantage of it 为不定式复合结构, 作后置定语修饰 the opportunity, 其中 it 指代前文的 differences between people。

7. **原文**: India shows what is happening.

译文: 印度的情况印证了正在发生的这一切。

常考词汇/短语:

- show v. 表明, 印证

8. **原文**: The country offers wealth for a few in the great cities and poverty for the remaining tribal peoples.

译文: 这个国家的大城市里少数人坐拥财富, 而其余的部落民族则身处贫困。

常考词汇/短语:

- wealth n. 财富
- poverty n. 贫困
- remaining adj. 剩余的, 其余的
- tribal peoples 部落民族

9. **原文**: The grand mediocrity of today — everyone being the same in survival and number of offspring — means that natural selection has lost 80% of its power in upper-middle-class India compared to the tribes.

译文: 当今这种大规模的平均化——所有人的存活率和子女数量都相差无几——意味着, 与部落群体相比, 自然选择在印度的中上层阶级中已经丧失了80%的作用。

常考词汇/短语:

- grand adj. 大规模的, 宏大的
- mediocrity n. 平庸, 平均化
- survival n. 存活, 生存
- upper-middle-class 中上层阶级
- compared to 与...相比

长难句结构分析:

主句主干为 The grand mediocrity of today means that...:

- 两个破折号之间为独立主格结构, 作插入语, 对前文的 mediocrity 进行解释说明;
- that 引导宾语从句, 从句主干为 natural selection has lost 80% of its power, in upper-middle-class India 为地点状语, compared to the tribes 为比较状语。

第二段段落概括

本段指出了导致人类进化停滞的第二个核心因素: 人类生育率的普遍趋同。如今人们的生育能力和生育数量都趋于平均, 人与人之间的差异大幅缩小, 自然选择可发挥作用的空間进一步缩减; 并以印度为例, 印证了社会发展后, 自然选择在发达群体中的效力已大幅丧失。

第三段

1. **原文**: For us, this means that evolution is over; the biological Utopia has arrived.

译文: 对我们而言, 这意味着进化已经终结; 生物学上的乌托邦已然到来。

常考词汇/短语:

- over adj. 结束的, 终结的
- biological adj. 生物学的
- Utopia n. 乌托邦

2. **原文**: Strangely, it has involved little physical change.

译文: 奇怪的是, 这一过程几乎没有带来任何身体上的变化。

常考词汇/短语:

- strangely adv. 奇怪的是
- involve v. 包含, 带来
- physical adj. 身体的, 生理的

3. **原文**: No other species fills so many places in nature.

译文: 没有其他任何物种能像人类一样占据自然界中如此多的生态位。

常考词汇/短语:

- species n. 物种
- fill v. 占据, 填满
- nature n. 自然界

4. **原文**: But in the past 100,000 years — even the past 100 years — our lives have been transformed but our bodies have not.

译文: 但在过去的10万年里——即便是过去的100年里——我们的生活发生了翻天覆地的变化, 可我们的身体却没有任何改变。

常考词汇/短语:

- transform v. 改变, 转变

5. **原文**: We did not evolve, because machines and society did it for us.

译文: 我们没有再进化, 因为机器和社会替我们完成了进化的过程。

常考词汇/短语:

- evolve v. 进化

6. **原文**: Darwin had a phrase to describe those ignorant of evolution: they “look at an organic being as a savage looks at a ship, as at something wholly beyond his comprehension.”

译文: 达尔文曾用一句话来描述那些对进化一无所知的人: 他们“看待有机体, 就像野蛮人看待一艘船, 如同看待某种完全无法理解的东西”。

常考词汇/短语:

- phrase n. 话语, 短语
- describe v. 描述
- ignorant of 对...无知, 不了解
- organic being 有机体
- savage n. 野蛮人
- wholly adv. 完全地
- beyond one's comprehension 超出某人的理解范围

长难句结构分析:

主句主干为 Darwin had a phrase to describe those ignorant of evolution, ignorant of evolution 作后置定语修饰 those:

- 冒号后的内容为直接引语, 作 phrase 的同位语;
- 引语主干为 they look at an organic being as a savage looks at a ship, as 引导方式状语从句;
- 第二个 as at something... 为省略结构, 完整形式为 as they look at something wholly beyond his comprehension, wholly beyond his comprehension 作后置定语修饰 something。

7. **原文**: No doubt we will remember a 20th century way of life beyond comprehension for its ugliness.

译文: 毫无疑问, 我们的后代会记得20世纪的生活方式, 会因其粗鄙不堪而感到无法理解。

常考词汇/短语:

- no doubt 毫无疑问
- ugliness n. 丑陋, 粗鄙

8. **原文**: But however amazed our descendants may be at how far from Utopia we were, they will look just like us.

译文: 但无论我们的后代会对我们当年离乌托邦的理想相去甚远感到多么震惊, 他们的样貌都会和我们别无二致。

常考词汇/短语:

- descendant n. 后代, 后裔
- amazed at 对...感到震惊
- far from 远离

长难句结构分析:

主从复合句，however 引导让步状语从句：

- 让步状语从句中，however amazed 相当于 no matter how amazed，从句主干为 our descendants may be amazed at...，at 后接 how 引导的宾语从句 how far from Utopia we were；
- 主句主干为 they will look just like us。

第三段段落概括

本段总结得出全文核心结论：人类的生物进化已经终结。尽管在过去的数万年里，人类的生活发生了翻天覆地的变化，但人类的身体并未发生进化，核心原因是机器与社会的发展替代了生物进化的作用；最终指出，即便千百年后，人类的生理样貌也不会发生改变。

三、完整原文与完整译文

完整原文

Being a man has always been dangerous. There are about 105 males born for every 100 females, but this ratio drops to near balance at the age of maturity, and among 70-year-olds there are twice as many women as men. But the great universal of male mortality is being changed. Now, boy babies survive almost as well as girls do. This means that, for the first time, there will be an excess of boys in those crucial years when they are searching for a mate. More important, another chance for natural selection has been removed. Fifty years ago, the chance of a baby (particularly a boy baby) surviving depended on its weight. A kilogram too light or too heavy meant almost certain death. Today it makes almost no difference. Since much of the variation is due to genes, one more agent of evolution has gone.

There is another way to commit evolutionary suicide: stay alive, but have fewer children. Few people are as fertile as in the past. Except in some religious communities, very few women have 15 children. Nowadays the number of births, like the age of death, has become average. Most of us have roughly the same number of offspring. Again, differences between people and the opportunity for natural selection to take advantage of it have diminished. India shows what is happening. The country offers wealth for a few in the great cities and poverty for the remaining tribal peoples. The grand mediocrity of today — everyone being the same in survival and number of offspring — means that natural selection has lost 80% of its power in upper-middle-class India compared to the tribes.

For us, this means that evolution is over; the biological Utopia has arrived. Strangely, it has involved little physical change. No other species fills so many places in nature. But in the past 100,000 years — even the past 100 years — our lives have been transformed but our bodies have not. We did not evolve, because machines and society did it for us. Darwin had a phrase to describe those ignorant of evolution: they “look at an organic being as a savage looks at a ship, as at something wholly beyond his comprehension.” No doubt we will remember a 20th century way of life beyond comprehension for its ugliness. But however amazed our descendants may be at how far from Utopia we were, they will look just like us.

完整译文

身为男性，从来都伴随着风险。男女出生比例约为105:100，但到了成年期，这一比例便下降至近乎持平，而在70岁的老人中，女性的数量是男性的两倍。但男性死亡率高这一普遍现象正在发生改变。如今，男婴的存活率几乎和女婴持平。这意味着，在男性寻找伴侣的关键年龄段，将首次出现男孩数量过剩的情况。更重要的是，自然选择发挥作用的又一个机会消失了。50年前，婴儿（尤其是男婴）的存活概率取决于其体重。体重过轻或过重一公斤，几乎就意味着必死无疑。如今，体重几乎不会产生任何影响。由于这种差异很大程度上是由基因决定的，进化的又一个驱动因素也消失了。

还有另一种方式会导致进化停滞：人能活得更久，但生育的子女更少了。很少有人像过去那样拥有旺盛的生育能力。除了在部分宗教社群中，极少有女性会生育15个孩子。如今，生育数量和寿命一样，都趋于平均化。我们大多数人的子女数量都大致相同。再一次，人与人之间的差异，以及自然选择利用这种差异发挥作用的机会，都已经减少了。印度的情况印证了正在发生的这一切。这个国家的大城市里少数人坐拥财富，而其余的部落民族则身处贫困。当今这种大规模的平均化——所有人的存活率和子女数量都相差无几——意味着，与部落群体相比，自然选择在印度的中上层阶级中已经丧失了80%的作用。

对我们而言，这意味着进化已经终结；生物学上的乌托邦已然到来。奇怪的是，这一过程几乎没有带来任何身体上的变化。没有其他任何物种能像人类一样占据自然界中如此多的生态位。但在过去的10万年里——即便是过去的100年里——我们的生活发生了翻天覆地的变化，可我们的身体却没有任何改变。我们没有再进化，因为机器和社会替我们完成了进化的过程。达尔文曾用一句话来描述那些对进化一无所知的人：他们“看待有机体，就像野蛮人看待一艘船，如同看待某种完全无法理解的东西”。毫无疑问，我们的后代会记得20世纪的生活方式，会因其粗鄙不堪而感到无法理解。但无论我们的后代会对我们当年离乌托邦的理想相去甚远感到多么震惊，他们的样貌都会和我们别无二致。